

Where Atlanta Real Estate Meets Rescue Dogs

Welcome to **Atlanta Homes & Hounds**, your monthly guide to the Atlanta real estate market, homeowner tips, local lifestyle insights, and featured rescue dogs looking for their forever homes. Written by Atlanta Realtor and rescue dog advocate Kya Sasena, this newsletter is for the people who believe home is more than just a place. It is where both people and dogs should feel like they belong. Whether you are buying, selling, or simply staying connected to the Atlanta community, you are in the right place.



Meet Milly

ADOPTABLE DOG OF THE MONTH

Looking for her Forever Home

Milly is a 3-year-old, 46-pound English Bulldog who came to Georgia English Bulldog Rescue (GEBR) after being passed between a breeder and another rescue. She had surgery in April to open her airways and is now healthy, active, and ready for her next chapter.

She loves toys, yard time, and her people, and does well with dogs, cats, and kids over 10. She still needs patience with leash and potty training, so an experienced owner is a must. She has come a long way and has so much more love to give.



GOOD WITH DOGS



GOOD WITH CATS



GOOD WITH KIDS 10+



ENGLISH BULLDOG

MEET MILLY AT GEBR →

DOG OWNER TIP • JUNE 2026

Summer-Proofing Your Home for Dogs

Summer in Atlanta means more backyard hangs, longer walks, and patio time with our pups, but warmer weather can also bring hidden hazards for dogs at home. A few thoughtful upgrades can make your space safer, cooler, and more dog-friendly all season long.

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Watch hot surfaces: Decks, patios, and pavement can burn sensitive paws. If it is too hot for your hand, it is too hot for their feet.
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Choose pet-safe landscaping: Azaleas, lilies, and sago palms can be toxic to dogs. Opt for pet-friendly greenery this season.
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Create shaded hydration spots: Cooling mats, umbrellas, and fresh water stations.comfortable outside.
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Screened porches are a game changer: Safe fresh air without bugs, overheating, or escape risks.
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Cooling-friendly flooring matters: Tile and luxury vinyl are easier on dogs in summer and hold up to muddy paws.

A truly dog-friendly home is not just about space — it is about a lifestyle that works for every member of the family, paws included.



Atlanta Market Update

Q1 2026 • METRO ATLANTA

Metro Atlanta heads into the new year in a **balanced market**. Rates are near **6.57%**, inventory is growing, and median prices hover around \$400K. Well-priced Buckhead and intown homes are still moving — preparation matters more than ever.



6.57% ▲

30-YR MORTGAGE RATE

vs. ~6.4% last year



~\$400K ▲

MEDIAN SALE PRICE

vs. ~\$384K last year



64 DAYS ▲

AVG DAYS ON MARKET

vs. ~51 days last year



+15% ▲

ACTIVE INVENTORY

vs. last year

Want neighborhood-specific stats? I pull local comps every month — just reach out.

This Month's Deep Dive

PROPERTY TAX APPEALS • ATLANTA METRO



Property tax appeals are one of the easiest ways homeowners can save money. Counties estimate your home's value each year, but those assessments are often higher than actual market value. By appealing with comparable sales and market data, you may be able to lower your annual tax bill and reduce future increases.

01



WHAT IT IS

Your county estimates your home's fair market value each year. Georgia assesses at 40% of that figure, and your tax bill flows from there. If their number is higher than what comparable homes are actually selling for, you are overpaying — and you can do something about it.

02



HOW TO APPEAL

You have 45 days from the date on your notice to file. Gather 3 to 5 comparable nearby sales, then submit your appeal at fultonassessor.org or your county's portal. If unresolved, you will attend a Board of Equalization hearing to present your case in person.

03



WHAT YOU GAIN

Win and your bill drops immediately. A successful appeal can freeze your assessed value for up to 3 years, shielding you from future increases even as the market rises. Fulton County deadlines typically fall in June and July — the window is open right now.

04



WHAT TO BRING

Recent sales of similar homes within half a mile, photos of your home's condition, any repair estimates for issues that affect value, and the county's own comparable sales (you can request these). The stronger your evidence, the better your outcome.



Not sure if your assessment is fair? I pull neighborhood comps every day. Send me your notice and I will take a look — no charge, no obligation.

ASK KYA →



MY COMMITMENT TO YOU

Every closing helps a dog find their forever home too.

When you buy or sell with me, I donate \$500 in your name to the rescue or shelter of your choice at closing. No strings. It is simply how I do business, because the people who love dogs tend to be exactly the kind of people I love working with.

\$500 PER CLOSED HOME
• YOUR CHOICE OF RESCUE

Let's Connect!

My inbox is always open so don't hesitate to reach out! If you know anyone buying or selling, I'd be honored to be your go-to referral. And be sure to scan the QR code below for free resources and more!



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BUCKHEAD